

TAMBARAM

Chromepet » Pallavaram » Tambaram West » Rajakilpakkam » Mannivakkam » Guindy » Keelkattalai » Nanganallur » Guduvanchery » Hasthinapuram » Pammal » Tambaram East

Medavakkam » Srinivasa Nagar » Kathipara Junction » Kovilambakkam » Sadasivam Nagar » Potheri » Selaiyur » Sembakkam » St.Thomas Mount » Madipakkam » Urappakkam » Paranur



MAPPING LESSONS BEYOND THE CLASSROOM

A geography teacher from the Government Model Higher Secondary School in Nandanam bagged two awards **P2**



SEVEN MONTHS PREGNANT AND ON THE PODIUM

After 22 years of dedication to the craft of karate, recognition at the national level arrives at an unlikely time for V. Anitha **P6**



A battered carriageway on Major Mukund Varadarajan Road in Medavakkam.

PHOTOS: SPECIAL ARRANGEMENT

Navigating this arterial road in Medavakkam is an excruciating experience

T.S. ATUL SWAMINATHAN

A section of Major Mukund Varadarajan Road in Medavakkam, between Medavakkam Main Road and Classical Language Road, is so badly bruised that motorists navigating it complain of back pain.

Even the road-margin areas are battered, posing a risk to the safety of pedestrians. Similarly, diagonally opposite the Medavakkam terminus, where routes 99, 95, 51A, and 51 stop, motorists have to be adept at negotiating potholes.

N. K. Raja, a social activist and a resident of Perumbakkam, says, "The carriageway is unsafe for two-wheeler riders. The State Highways Department should inspect and re-



lay the stretch on a war-footing."

The concrete-and-tar patchwork along the margins and on the road near Kamarajar Garden and VGP Pushpa Nagar offers no relief to road users.

Walking along VGP Pushpa Nagar after the rains is treacherous.

The tar patchwork on the battered surfaces has created uneven patches, forcing motorists to endure a risky ride.

Only along Moovendar Nagar had the CMRL recently relaid the road outside Annai Theresa Hospital.

Near Madambakkam Main Road, below the Medavakkam overpass, where motorists from Main Road take a right turn to enter Major Road, on the lane towards Pallikaranai, the prolem hits the nadir, says D. Priya, a resident of Medavakkam.

Flight and fight



On September 4, the Officers Training Academy in St Thomas Mount had cadets showcase a host of activities that displayed their physical fitness. Organised as a prelude to the passing out parade of officer cadets of SSC-122 and SSC(W)-36, some of the events included equestrian display, kalarippayattu and bunker busting drill. PHOTOS: VELANKANNI RAJ B

Social activist loses 'pillar of support'

T.S. ATUL SWAMINATHAN

S. Srimathi, wife of social activist and Chromepet resident V. Santhanam, passed away on August 28, 2026, at the age of 79 due to prolonged illness.

She was the backbone and strength of Santhanam, who at 88, continues to raise issues concerning residents with various authorities.

Many years ago, there was an attempt on his life, but Santhanam survived it after prolonged treatment, one that ran for three months. "Srimathi pleaded with me to stop my social activism, but I did not. She understood my commitment and



became my pillar of strength. She took responsibility for the education of my children while I went about taking up civic issues," said Santhanam.

Fellow activists remember Srimathi amma for her simplicity and humility.

Srimathi amma was the first to highlight the difficulties faced by pedestrians walking on MIT flyover service lane and GST Road, especially due to encroachments. She also drew attention to the challenges people faced while climbing the staircases at Chromepet footbridge in the absence of escalators.

Whenever officials, politicians, and social activists visited Santhanam's residence, Srimathi would be the perfect host, serving them sweets, savouries or a beverage.

Santhanam and Srimathi ran Sri Saranagathi Seva Trust, a charitable organisation dedicated to helping poor children who are hospitalised. Whenever appeals for donations were sought through advertisements in *The Hindu* to treat underprivileged children, the Trust would send funds. Srimathi personally collected donations from friends and relatives and ensured that the money reached hospitals directly through the Trust.

During the COVID-19 pandemic, she provided meals daily to 50-100 people in need. On Deepavali and Pongal, she distributed saris and dhotis to those in need – a noble service she carried out continuously for the last 15 years.

People can contact V Santhanam at 9444254850.



Chromepet Humour Club meets today

The monthly meeting of the Chromepet Humour Club will be held on September 6 at Government Higher Secondary School, Hasthinapuram (near the bus terminus).

The session will be held from 4 p.m. to 6 p.m. T. B. Sathiyarayanan, former Deputy General Manager, Lakshmi Villas Bank, will be the chief guest.

For details, call 63822 66727.

LIFY THOMAS

With two awards, it was double the delight for this Geography teacher from Government Model Higher Secondary School in Nandanam, on September 5 when he received the Dr. Radhakrishnan Best Teacher Award from the Tamil Nadu government. And on September 6, the post graduate teacher will be among ten teachers to receive the Vidhya Seva Samman.

Following teaching stints in Ethiopia and a few Indian states, 12 years ago, R. Subramanian eased into the role as government school teacher at KLK Boys Higher Secondary School in Gummidipoondi.

One would have expected the teacher to face a huge culture shock moving to a geography that hugely contrasts with the one he previously operated in, but that was not the case. "From the word go, it was smooth sailing at this school in Tiruvallur district. I am good in classroom management and have also prepared modules to train teachers," he says.

Since 2017, Subramanian has been associated with the school in Nandanam. He worked on bringing about behavioural changes in teenagers. He believes that life's most important lessons are best taught beyond the four walls of the classroom. Be a friend to teenagers, not just their teacher, he says.

A tree planting exercise he initiated on the school campus was much appreciated.

"Engaging students in activities such as nurturing saplings and painting the walls of the school with social message are a few ways I built a rapport with students who would otherwise skip classes," says the 54-year-old teacher who is a resident of Madipakkam.

One of the Subramanian's pet



Mapping lessons beyond the classroom

Madipakkam resident and geography teacher from the Government Model Higher Secondary School in Nandanam bagged two awards

initiatives is anchoring the morning assembly, where relevant news in science and technology or current affairs is presented to students in a capsule format through stories or Thirukkural. This is followed by a question and answer session where students giving the right answer are given goodies by the school headmistress.

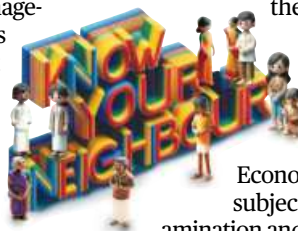
Beyond the classroom, the "geography sir" is a resource person

with the School Education Department on school safety, a visiting faculty for civil service coaching at Anna Institute of Management in Greenways Road and a trainer at Naan Mudhalvan Competitive Exams programme.

In most institutions with higher secondary classes, science and commerce are pre-

ferred groups for students. Subramanian has been changing this thinking in students by providing them with an understanding of careers in UPSC and TNPSC.

He says: "History, Geography and Economics are among core subjects in civil service examination and focussing on them is essential."



Award ceremony today at Gopalapuram

Vidhya Seva Samman is a initiative of Mission Guru Devo Bhava in association with Lions Club of Meenambakkam and Vedritam Group (formerly DAV Group, Chennai). The 10 teachers who will be receiving the award on September 6 are: Kala Raman from P.S. Higher Secondary School, Mylapore; Thanukrishnan J. from Smt Durgadevi Choudhary Vivekananda Vidyalaya Senior Secondary School, Kolathur; Shalika Banu from Fathima Central Senior Secondary School; G Sripriya from Motilal Fomra Sanatana Dharma Higher Secondary School, Sowcarpet; J. R. Lakshmi Kantham from The Children's Garden Higher Secondary School, Mylapore; K. Revathy from Chennai Higher Secondary School, Alwarpettai; Janaki G. from Lady Sivaswami Ayyar Girls Higher Secondary School, Mylapore; Sujatha Mukundan from Shri Natesan Vidyasala Matriculation Higher Secondary School; Seema Madan from Kola Saraswathi Vaishnav Senior Secondary School; and R. Subramanian from Govt. Model School, Nandanam.

S. Gurumurthy, columnist and editor of Thuglak will be the chief guest at the award function happening on September 6 at DAV Girls Senior Secondary School in Gopalapuram from 10.30 a.m. onwards. Anil Khicha, co-founder, Mission Guru Devo Bhava, says they received 217 nominations out of which 185 applications were screened by a team of seven screening committee members who shortlisted 20. These finalists were further assessed by an eminent panel of jury who selected 10 for the Vidhya Seva Samman.

Civic disarray at school zone in Chromepet

Students, parents and residents of Gajalakshmi Nagar seek permanent solutions to pothole-ridden roads, polluted water overflowing from a stormwater channel and inadequate road safety measures around SRDF Vivekananda Vidyalaya

T. ARVIND

While bad roads and sewage-mixed water on roads have been reported from Chromepet on several occasions, a cluster of civic issues around a major educational institution in the locality has caused concern among students, parents and residents.

Smt. Ramkuwar Devi Fomra Vivekananda Vidyalaya, popularly known as SRDF Vivekananda Vidyalaya, caters to more than 3,000 students at four locations in and around Gajalakshmi Nagar.

The First Main Road in Gajalakshmi Nagar, under Ward 36 of the Tambaram Corporation, which leads to the rear entrance of the main school building, is riddled with potholes, crater-like pits and uneven patches. Students who cycle to school find it difficult to negotiate the stretch.

“My legs got twisted once when I pedalled on the stretch,” said V. Rohan Malolan, a class XII student. MTC buses and tipper lorries also use the road to connect the north-

ern and southern parts of the neighbourhood, adding to the concern over the condition of the road.

Safety concerns mount

At Mahadevan Street, where the main entrance to the school is located, polluted water has been overflowing from an open rainwater harvesting (RWH) channel



▼ The uneven surface of First Main Road in Gajalakshmi Nagar; and a polluted stormwater channel at the entrance to SRDF Vivekananda Vidyalaya in Mahadevan Street, Chromepet. PHOTOS: T. ARVIND

He said there had been instances of schoolchildren falling into drains during the monsoon when the water level rose above the road level. While closed concrete stormwater channels had been provided on several roads, the authorities should find a permanent solution for the channel and consider covering it, at least in the school zone, he said.

Councillor C. Saraswathi said the issue had been brought to the notice of Corporation officials repeatedly, but remained unresolved. She added that the problem had worsened after debris from a newly constructed residential building was dumped on the stretch, blocking the channel.

On the potholed road, Saraswathi said the rise in the cost of bitumen had led to tenders being put on hold and that ‘concrete patchwork’ would be carried out.

“This will create another headache,” said Gopi, a nearby resident, pointing out that uneven patches could cause further inconvenience to road users. “Nothing can replace a pucca tar road,” he said.

Parthiban said volunteers, mostly retired professionals and parents and guardians of schoolchildren, regulated traffic during peak hours. He said speed breakers conforming to Indian Roads Congress norms should also be installed near the school.

A similar problem of polluted or sewage-mixed water rising to road level has also been reported on Lakshmi Street in Saraswathi Colony, Hasthinapuram.

meant to carry storm water. Located right opposite the school entrance, the overflowing water poses health and safety concerns for students and causes inconvenience to parents.

“The water spilled over on to the road during the normal rains a few days ago,” said Poonguzhali, a parent.

According to Parthiban, Administrative Officer of SRDF Chromepet, the school had already sent a formal complaint to the Corporation and raised the issue several times. “They are yet to fix it. We placed slabs over the RWH channel at our own cost as a temporary safety measure, but that cannot be a permanent solution,” he said.

RWA thanks corporation for including Chitlapakkam in water scheme

Members of the Chitlapakkam Muthulakshmi Nagar Welfare Association have expressed their gratitude to the State Government and Tambaram City Municipal Corporation for including the region in the Chennai Metro Water scheme. This has been a long-standing demand of resident groups in the area.

L. Sundararaman, president of Chitlapakkam Muthulakshmi Nagar Welfare Association, says, “Severe drinking water shortage, coupled with insufficient rainfall, has accelerated the decision to include Chitlapakkam. With this connection, we hope to receive water at least on alternate days. At present, we receive water once every four to five days. Apart from this, additional storage tanks should also be constructed.”



Residents plant saplings at lake bund under the second phase

The second phase of planting saplings at the bund of Thiruneermalai Periya Eri was held recently. Employees from Tata Consultancy Services, along with Naanai – a group of volunteers from the banking and IT sectors – residents of Thiruneermalai and volunteers of the Thiruneermalai Periya Eri Paadhukaappu Kuzhu (TPEPK) took part.

More than 40 people took part, and 500 palm saplings, and a good number of native saplings of neem, banyan, pongai, and poovarasam were planted on the bund of Thiruneermalai Periya Eri along Thiruneermalai Road.

Volunteers from the Saving Nammangalam Lake Team, including R Sathya, M. Ravi Muthaiya from Chitlapakkam (Sembakkam Lake), and A.

Darwin Annadurai from Eco-Society India participated.

At the end of the drive, the volunteers and conservancy staff had breakfast.

B. Saravanan, a core volunteer with TPEPK, says the saplings, once they grow into trees, will serve as a habitat for birds and maintain the lake ecosystem.

“The saplings (first and second phases) have been planted along Thiruneermalai Road - the northern side lake bund. On the southern, western, and eastern sides (opposite the Madras Export Processing Zone, along Chennai Bypass Road, and Lakshmiapuram and The New Colony localities), work to level the bunds is underway.”

Once the bunds are ready, the saplings will be planted there as well.

Relocate **TASMAC** outlet from Sembakkam

T.S. ATUL SWAMINATHAN

Residents want a Tamil Nadu State Marketing Corporation (TASMAC) outlet on Sembakkam - Nanmangalam Road relocated as it is causing public nuisance and traffic issues in the area.

R. Sathya, a core volunteer at the Saving Nanmangalam Lake Team and a resident of Sembakkam, recently struggled to get past this stretch of the road for an activity pertaining to the lake.

"The road is narrow, and even pedestrians cannot walk freely. The tippers throw trash and relieve themselves in the open and in an unused canal.

The tippers consume liquor in the open and fight among themselves on the road. The road is used by children from the Nanmangalam region to go to schools in Sembakkam and Hasthinapuram," says Sathya.

R. Arun Kumar, a resident of Sembakkam, says, "In the last two months, we met M. Veerappan, Collector, Chengalpattu district; K. Vignesh, State Minister of Pro-



Tipplers near the outlet on Sembakkam - Nanmangalam Road in the Sembakkam region. PHOTO: SPECIAL ARRANGEMENT

hibition and Excise and Tambaram assembly constituency MLA; D. Sarath Kumar and C. Venkatraman, secretary, Ward 40, Sembakkam, Tamizhaga Vetri Kazhagam."

Arun says that as the outlet is located close to places of worship and roughly about 500 meters from Zion School, there is every reason for it to be relocated.

Venkatraman said he has escalated the issue to the relevant Ministries and is hopeful that it will be included in the next list for removal of shops.

These outlets in Chromepet and Guindy should go

V SANTHANAM AND P. SATHYANARAYANAN

After assuming charge as Chief Minister of Tamil Nadu, C. Joseph Vijay ordered the closure of more than 700 liquor outlets near educational institutions, places of worship and bus terminals.

But the outlets along and near Chromepet and MIT foot overbridges have not been removed. Similarly, an outlet in Guindy along the railway station.

The outlet is a nuisance because countless pedestrians use the footbridge and the subway to reach Anna Salai and Race Course Road. The outlet is a stone's throw away from the bridge and the underpass.

Countless people have to walk among tippers to access the bridges (on the MIT bridge to reach Nehru Nagar and Chitlapakkam Main Road) and to reach the subway and railway stations. We do not know how the shops are being run or how this escaped the notice of the TASMAC staff, with tippers creating a nuisance and using abusive language at pedestrians. The outlet in Guindy is open in the morning during rush hour.

V Santhanam and P. Sathyana-
rayanan are senior social activists
and residents of Chromepet and
Guindy respectively

Two places on GST Road that need FOB



Two places in the southern suburbs that would need foot overbridges are Urappakkam-Nandhivaram Guduvancherry, and Guduvancherry regions.

The footbridges should be constructed by the National Highways Authority of India (NHAI) on the stretch where there are apartments, a hospital and clinics.

"An FOB outside the hospital

will help patients, and residents of apartment communities, Featherlite Vaikuntam, Akshaya The Belvedere and Udhaya Sooriyan Nagar," said S. Aarthi, a resident of the locality.



Pedestrians are at risk of accidents while crossing GST Road in Urappakkam. PHOTO: SPECIAL ARRANGEMENT

The nearest pedestrian crossing is at Adhiparasakthi Nagar or Karanai Puducherry Main Road and GST Road, Urappakkam. "This is too long for pedestrians to cross," Aarthi pointed out.

"Similarly, further down the stretch, near Mahalakshmi Nagar, or Mahalakshmi Nagar Extension, an FOB would benefit residents of Radha Nagar and students at Loknayak Jayaprakash Narayan Vidyalaya," said R. Malini Ramakrishnan,

a resident of Mahalakshmi Nagar.

Without an FOB, pedestrians are forced to risk their lives by crossing the busy highway. Many stand in the middle of the road, amidst fast-moving vehicles, and some jump over barricades or walk along the barricades. The absence of speed breakers further increases the risk of collisions. Pedestrians frequently halt traffic, which can lead to multiple collisions.

Geopolitics in a tea cup



In addition to the unique flavours that teas from the Government-run TanTea plantations and factory in The Nilgiris bring to the cup, the lingering taste comes from what the initiative represents: helping Tamil repatriates from Sri Lanka, from the 1970s onwards. T. Arunkumar who runs a TanTea dealership with three outlets in Chennai, along with his father S. Thiruvassagam, on the heady combination of empowerment and tea tasting

LAKSHMY HARIKRISHNAN

A sprinkle of TanTea retail tea shops operate across Tamil Nadu, largely run by distributors of Tamilnadu Tea Plantation Cooperation Limited, shortened to TanTea. In Chennai, habitués of Mylapore have likely noticed a TanTea shop abutting the Kapaleeswarar temple tank on RK Mutt Road. If they have not, they cannot be a habitué of that part of town, as this outlet pitched tent there nearly 11 years ago.

And it is likely that even the habitués of that area are unaware that those teas sold in cups as well as in packets in cover designs befitting a brand have a connection with the TanTea headquarters and factory on Orange Grove Road at Conoor. The packets are shipped from there. The odds are even lower that they know that tea plantations in The Nilgiris that follow the clonal plantation model support the making of those teas. And it is even more likely that they do not know that “kindness” is an ingredient that went into the establishment of TanTea. When it was established in 1968 under the Chief Ministership of C.N. Annadurai, it was known as Government Tea Project. From the 1970s onwards, the Tamil Nadu Government had kept these plantations going to support Tamil repatriates from Sri Lanka, providing

them with livelihoods linked to the maintenance of the plantations and the production of teas. Reportedly, the initiative received a huge impetus from M.G. Ramachandran during his terms as Chief Minister of Tamil Nadu as he viewed it as a vehicle delivering justice to uprooted Sri Lankan Tamils.

These are the factors that make what swirls in that cup at a TanTea

outlet special, of course in addition to the unique flavours and taste those teas bring to the teapot.

The Mylapore outlet is run by a TanTea dealership, Giri and Co, whose reins are wielded by the father-son duo of S. Thiruvassagam and T. Arunkumar. They have two other outlets, one at Kotturpuram on Gandhi Mandapam Road, inside the CM’s Call Centre premises,

widely known as Government Data Centre, and the other at the Kilambakkam Bus Terminus; both outlets are of recent mint, having been established in 2025 and 2024 respectively.

Of the three outlets, the one at Mylapore is an outlier in terms of operational timings. It functions 24 hours, except from a break between 1.30 a.m. and 3.30 a.m., with

workers employed on a shift system. The outlet at Kotturpuram functions more like a canteen, the eats varied and meant to be more filling as students from the Anna University nearby as well as those from the Madras School of Economics, located behind the Government Data Centre, step in regularly in addition to the general crowd. On why run a TanTea outlet when fresh competition is always brewing in the tea drinking market, a new chain of pocket-sized tea shops always appearing on the horizon from nowhere, Arunkumar remarks it is partly because of the history of empowerment that goes with the brand, and in part due to the unique appeal those teas make to taste buds.

Arunkumar believes that once the customers taste it, the product speaks for itself. And Arunkumar lines up impressive numbers in terms of footfall for the three outlets, each of which offers eats from its kitchen to go with a range of TanTea teas, including what he calls the latest sensation, fruit and flower teas. The milk tea however remains the major grosser.

From his experience, the tea cup at his TanTea outlets is a leveller, bringing students, corporate employees, auto drivers and bus drivers and conductors, among others, to the same table. He was making a specific reference to the outlet on RK Mutt Road near the Mylapore temple tank: “before Metro Rail work arrived in this area, MTC buses would be parked on RK Mutt Road along the temple tank, and the bus crew would park themselves at the outlet for steaming cups of tea.”

Relationship with Mylapore extends beyond commerce and encompasses community. Arunkumar observes that for nearly a decade, the shop joined the 63 Nayanmars festival at the Kapaleeshwar Temple by ensuring free supply of cool drinks, hot teas and coffees, snacks and even packed cooked rice varieties for four days, serving around 400 people each day. Arunkumar notes his outlets at Mylapore and Kotturpuram have drawn celebrities from within the city, cricketer Sri Sudharshan’s visit being etched in his memory. The photo he clicked with the batsman is a proud possession in his mobile storage folder.

(Clockwise from top): TanTea outlets in Kotturpuram, Kilambakkam and Mylapore.

'Unblock Patta for properties in Thalambur'

Over 20,000 Families in Limbo: FOMRRA Appeal to TN Government to Unblock Thalambur Patta Following Supreme Court Order SLP (c) Nos. 24430-24431/2019*

Federation of OMR Residents Associations (FOMRRA) has appealed to the Government of Tamil Nadu to unblock the Patta for properties in Thalambur (specifically Survey No. 161/1 and surrounding areas). FOMRRA has been actively highlighting this critical issue for a

few years now.

A FOMRRA press release says that following the Honorable Supreme Court's final order on April 22, 2026, which vacated the previous 2019 *status quo*, the associations are requesting immediate administrative action.

The ongoing Patta blockade has completely frozen property registrations, sales, and emergency transactions, causing severe distress to over 20,000 innocent families, says release.

The crisis spans across hundreds of acres and has severely impacted numerous established communities, institutions, and innocent individuals. Affected entities include gated communities and educational institutions in Thalambur.

These are not vacant lands, but thriving communities and homes purchased with the life savings of innocent citizens. With the state-appointed enquiry committee's deadline having expired on August 22,



Representational picture

2026, the residents earnestly request the Chief Minister and Revenue authorities to swiftly adopt a practical, humane, and legally sus-

tainable resolution to protect the homeowners' rights and update the 20,000 families about the action taken, the release adds.

Seven months pregnant and on the podium

After 22 years of dedication to the craft of karate, recognition at the national level arrives at an unlikely time for V. Anitha

B. PRABHU

"V. Anitha from Chennai bags gold in KATA at an All India Karate Championship." As the reader would note, that is a regular line one that jumps at them every other morning from newsprint.

Read the line now bolstered with other details that went with that achievement.

"V. Anitha, 30 years old, a resident of Ramapuram in Chennai, bags gold in the Individual Kata competition at the All India Karate Championship held at Vatakara in Kerala, on August 29 and 30, 2026. And she was seven months pregnant."

The two-day championship, conducted by Alan Thilak Karate School, drew the participation of more than 1,500 students across categories for men and women. The Kerala team won the overall championship title and the Tamil



V. Anitha. PHOTOS: SPECIAL ARRANGEMENT

Nadu team secured second place.

Anitha could head to that championship clearly because her family, particularly her husband Prithiviraj, backed her in that decision; but the larger motive power that got her there, and eventually onto the podium, is the sense of practising karate, in the competitive arena and outside.

Anitha began learning karate when she was studying in Class III, actively participating in competitions and winning several prizes

even in her school days. When she was in Class X, she faced opposition from her family regarding her decision to persist with karate. However, she remained determined, won her family over to her point of view and continued her training.

She later joined SIET College and completed her B.Com degree. She subsequently worked with Larsen & Toubro (L&T) and other corporate organisations. Although she had established a career in the corporate sector, karate remained her



lifelong passion. She eventually made a conscious decision to leave her corporate career, not because of work commitments, but because she wanted to make karate her "profession and purpose in life" and use what she had learned to contribute to society.

A major influence throughout her journey has been her guru, Hanshi A. Appuraj, an 8th Dan

Black Belt with more than 40 years of experience in karate. A national champion in 1996, Hanshi A. Appuraj has trained more than 10,000 students and continues to guide karate practitioners as an instructor of Alan Thilak Karate School. Anitha has trained under his guidance for more than 22 years, making his mentorship an integral part of her journey.

Anitha's training under Alan Thilak Karate School, founded by Dai Sensei Moses Thilak, has also been an important part of her martial arts career. The legacy of the institution is now being carried forward under the technical leadership of Sensei Neil Moses and other senior technical directors.

Over more than two decades, Anitha has built an impressive competitive record. She has been a Thiruvallur District Women's Category Champion for more than 10 years, along with several achievements at the State and National levels. She has participated and won medals in numerous district, state and national-level championships. In February 2026, she also secured a medal at the State Championship.

Her achievements have extended beyond the competition arena. She received the Young Achiever Award from the Department of Commerce at SIET College, recognising her accomplishments and contribution.

After choosing karate as her profession, Anitha began using her experience to empower others. She currently works as a 5th Dan Black Belt, Karate master, self-defence coach and personal safety strategist. She conducts martial arts, self-defence and personal safety programmes for women employees in corporate organisations, college students and school girls.

In 2024, Anitha married Prithiviraj, who has continued to support her karate journey and goals, chief aiming them is empowering women with self-defence training.

Students of Medavakkam school showcase talent

Sujay Public School held its eighth Annual Sports Meet with great zeal and enthusiasm. Giridharini Ravikumar, a national athletic champion, was the chief guest. In her address, she motivated the students to inculcate sportsmanship, be disciplined, and persevere to excel in life.

Sportspersons were awarded for their exemplary achievement in

events. Students showcased their talents through aerobics, drill performances, pyramid formation, karate, silambam, and yoga demonstration, said a release from the school.

The members of the school management, the senior principal, and the principal took part.

Dignitaries at the event.



Alumni association launches digital platform



The Alumni Association of Sri Ramachandra Institute of Higher Education & Research launched its digital alumni engagement platform recently. According to a press release, it is supported by a software called AlmaShines.

The event witnessed the partici-

pation of around 500 alumni from various batches. Three distinguished alumni took part as special guests. They are: Dr. Haripriya Aravind, Head of Cataract and IOL Services, Aravind Eye Hospital, Chennai; Dr. Saveetha Rajesh, Director, The Pupil International School and NMV University, Chennai; and Dr.

Yashwanth Kumar V., Honorary Consul of the Republic of El Salvador. On the occasion, the association awarded scholarships to meritorious students. The platform was inaugurated by SRIHER chancellor V.R. Venkataachalam in the presence of trustee Samyuktha Venkatachalam, adds the press release.

Shotgun shooters from SRM IST bag medals

SRM IST shotgun shooters delivered an outstanding performance at the 27th South Zone shooting championship (Shotgun Event) held at the Royal Pudukkottai Sports Club, Pudukkottai, recently. Aisshika Dinkar Kumar, III B.Arch, Kattankulathur campus, secured two gold medals in the Double Trap junior and women's categories, while Hrithikesh, I B.Tech, Ramapuram campus, won one gold medal in the Double Trap junior men's Category and one silver medal in the Double Trap youth men's category.



Don Bosco wins inter-school cricket tourney



Don Bosco defeated Heartfulness (Omega) by 23 runs in the final of the Heartfulness Omega Coaching Beyond u-14 inter-school cricket tournament held recently.

The scores (final):

Don Bosco 215/7 in 50 overs (Jaikrishwin 44, Saif Ali 35, Sarvesh 34) bt Heartfulness International School Omega NIOS 192 in

48.2 overs (Aadil Asrani 58, Ishaan Krishnan 35, Prithvin Prem 41).

Special Awards

Man of the match: G. Sarvesh (Don Bosco MHSS); Emerging player of the match: Aadil Asrani (Heartfulness International School Omega NIOS); best batsman: Aadil Asrani (Heartfulness International School Omega NIOS); best

bowler: Bragdeesh Aditya (St. John's Public School); best fielder: Smaran Vithlani (Heartfulness International School Omega NIOS); best wicketkeeper: Aswin Srikanth (St. John's Public School); emerging player of the tournament: V. Sachin (St. Bede's AIHSS); most valuable player of the tournament: Prithvin Prem (Heartfulness International School Omega NIOS).

Best Bargains

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An uninviting sight



Garbage dumped outside Government Higher Secondary School in Medavakkam, next to the Medavakkam Village Panchayat office, presents an unwelcoming picture for students. This problem has been going on for some years. N. K. Raja, president of Nesamani Nagar Residents' Welfare Association, Perumbakkam, had lodged a complaint with the Chengalpattu District Collectorate, but no action has been taken to address this problem.

Waiting for Kilambakkam FOB



Once work on the Kilambakkam footbridge on GST Road is completed, it will provide a link between Kilambakkam railway station and the Kalaingar Centenary Bus Terminus (KCBT). The bridge will be a big boon to commuters and long-distance passengers who alight from State Government and private long-distance buses and cross the road to reach the Metropolitan Transport Corporation bus terminus inside KCBT. PHOTO AND TEXT: R. RAVINDRAN.

Celebrating two milestone years

The Inner Wheel Club of Adyar's flagship annual fundraiser event, Dandiya Dhamaka, will be held on September 19

The Inner Wheel Club of Adyar is gearing up to celebrate two significant milestones this year – 40 years of community service and the 10th anniversary of Dandiya Dhamaka, its flagship annual fundraiser.

Over the past four decades, the Club has undertaken many initiatives in education, women empowerment, environmental sustainability, elder care, renovation of school infrastructure, and support for the underprivileged. Its long-standing environmental efforts include the planting of over 50,000 saplings.

A major focus over the last two years has been "Project Vision - Giving Little Eyes a Better Tomorrow." Through Gurupriya Vision Research Foundation, the Club contributes towards laser surgery for premature infants affected by Retinopathy of Prematurity (ROP), a preventable cause of childhood blindness. Each eye surgery costs approximately ₹10,000, and the Club has so far supported successful surgeries

for over 60 babies, said a release.

Supporting projects such as these is Dandiya Dhamaka, the Club's annual fundraiser, which completes 10 years in 2026. What began as a fundraising initiative has grown into a much-awaited celebration exclusively for women, bringing together dance, music, shopping and festive cheer – all for a larger purpose.

Want to join the club?

The Inner Wheel Club of Adyar, under District 323, is part of International Inner Wheel, a global organisation of women dedicated to friendship and service. The Club in Adyar was founded on September 16, 1986 with just 19 members. Today, the club has grown into a warm and vibrant community of 39 members, united by our motto: "Friendship and Service." Members meet once a month, either at a member's home or at the registered meeting place of the Club. Our meetings provide an opportunity to build friendships, share ideas, and participate in meaningful service activities that make a positive difference in the community, said the release. The Club welcome women of all ages to join them. They can start by attending a meeting, get to know members and activities, and then decide whether they would like to become part of our Inner Wheel family.



Members of the club and during a dandiya event.



Proceeds from the fundraiser supports the Club's charitable initiatives. This year's Dandiya Dhamaka will be held on September 19, from 5 p.m. to 8 p.m. at MGR Arangam, MGR Janaki College of Arts and Science, Adyar. The ladies only evening will feature

dance, music, raffle and shopping, with entry and dinner at ₹700 per person.

For dandiya tickets and sponsorship enquiries, contact Meera Suresh, President at 96772 48172/ Rajameenakshi ISO at 98408 86648